

THE VANISHED SCHOOL MASCOT

Shadow School Halloween Investigation

Student Detective Workbook • A2 • Listening • Grammar • Speaking

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Case Briefing

It is Halloween evening at Shadow School. The school mascot, Shadow the Owl, has vanished from its perch in the Great Hall. The Halloween parade starts at 7:30. The principal asks you, the student detective, to find the owl before the parade. You have 45 minutes. Listen carefully, collect clues, and speak your ideas. Do not guess — use only the information you hear.

Your Mission: Find Shadow the Owl and explain what happened.

Task 1. Listening Grid — “Who / Where / When”

Skill: Listening • Stage: Input • Items: 5

Listen once. Complete the grid with the exact information you hear.

Person	Place	Time	Object	Action
1.				
2.				
3.				
4.				
5.				

Hint: Listen for names and clock times. Write only what you hear.

Task 2. Listen & Order — “The Evening Sequence”

Skill: Listening • Stage: Input • Items: 6

Listen again. Number the events 1–6 in the order you hear them.

☐ A. Alex arrived and looked for his gloves.

☐ B. Cora saw a shadow past the window.

☐ C. Mrs Grey last saw the owl.

☐ D. The lights flickered.

☐ E. Ben finished cleaning and left.

☐ F. There was a loud noise near the hall door.

Hint: The first event is the earliest time.

Task 3. Second Listening: Find the Clue — “Hidden Details”

Skill: Listening • Stage: Evidence • Items: 4

Listen a second time. Write the four clues you hear.

1. Time the owl was last seen: _____

2. What Cora saw: _____

3. Where Ms Hollow was: _____

4. What Alex was looking for: _____

Hint: Numbers and places are important.

Task 4. Audio Timeline — “Reconstruct the Hour”

Skill: Listening — Stage: Deduction — Items: 6

Use the information from the recordings. Write the events on the timeline.

5:40 _____

5:45 _____

6:00 _____

6:10 _____

6:15 _____

6:30 _____

Hint: Use the grid and the order task.

Task 5. Evidence Passport — “Check Every Clue”

Skill: Integrated Stage: Deduction Items: 5

For each piece of evidence, complete the passport.

Evidence	Source	Fact	Meaning	Reliability
1. Last sighting				
2. Shadow past window				
3. Note on the floor				
4. Black gloves				
5. Art-room painting				

Hint: High = direct witness; Low = possible trick.

Task 6. Clue Unlock — “Open the Next Door”

Skill: Integrated Stage: Evidence Items: 5

Finish each mini-task. Each correct answer unlocks one clue.

1. Complete: If we check the art room, we _____ (find) the owl.
2. Circle the correct time: The noise was at 6:00 / 6:10 / 6:30.
3. Write the person who was in the library: _____
4. True or False: Ben was still in the school at 6:15. _____
5. Complete: If Alex finds his gloves, he _____ (show) them to us.

Hint: Use will + verb for the conditionals.

Task 7. Possible / Impossible — “Test the Versions”

Skill: Logic & inference Stage: Deduction Items: 6

Mark each version Possible or Impossible. Give a short reason from the evidence.

1. Ben took the owl after 6:00. _____ Reason: _____
2. Cora moved the owl while she was in the library. _____ Reason: _____
3. Ms Hollow moved the owl to the art room. _____ Reason: _____
4. Alex hid the owl before he arrived at 6:30. _____ Reason: _____
5. The lights flickering helped someone move the owl. _____ Reason: _____
6. The note is completely true. _____ Reason: _____

Hint: Check the times first.

Task 8. Missing Piece — “What We Still Need”

Skill: Logic & inference Stage: Inference Items: 4

For each question, write what information is still missing.

1. Did anyone see Ms Hollow leave the art room?
Missing: _____

2. What exactly does the note say about the closet?
Missing: _____

3. Are the black gloves Alex’s?
Missing: _____

4. Was the perch empty or moved?
Missing: _____

Task 9. Motive — Evidence — Suspect — “Connect the Dots”

Skill: Logic & inference Stage: Deduction Items: 5

Match or write the best connection for each line.

1. Motive: wanted a surprise decoration → Evidence: _____ → Suspect: _____

2. Motive: late arrival and missing gloves → Evidence: _____ → Suspect: _____

3. Motive: was cleaning and left early → Evidence: _____ → Suspect: _____

4. Motive: was reading and saw a shadow → Evidence: _____ → Suspect: _____

5. Motive: possible prank with a note → Evidence: _____ → Suspect: _____

Evidence Board



Use this board throughout the investigation. Update it after each task.

WHAT WE KNOW	SUSPECTS
• Owl last seen 5:45, Great Hall • Noise at 6:10 • Shadow at 6:15 • Cora in library 6:00–6:25 • Ms Hollow in art room • Ben left at 5:40 • Alex arrived 6:30 • Note found on floor	• Ms Hollow • Alex • Ben • Cora
EVIDENCE	QUESTIONS
• Timeline • Shadow sighting • Note • Gloves • Art-room activity	• Is the note true? • Did Ms Hollow leave the art room? • Whose gloves are they?
WHAT CHANGED (write here)	

Final Verdict



Write your conclusion. Use at least two pieces of evidence. Reject the strongest wrong idea. Use one Conditional 1 sentence.

My conclusion:

_____

_____

Evidence 1: _____

Evidence 2: _____

I reject this idea because:

_____

If we _____ , we will _____ .

Teacher Answer Key

All answers are traceable to the listening script. Do not give this page to students before the lesson.

Listening Script (for teacher)

“This is Mrs Grey, the caretaker. I last saw Shadow the Owl at 5:45 pm on its perch in the Great Hall. At 6:00 the lights flickered. I heard a loud noise at 6:10 near the hall door. Cora was in the library from 6:00 to 6:25. She saw a shadow move past the window at 6:15. Ms Hollow was in the art room painting pumpkins. Ben the janitor finished cleaning at 5:40 and left. Alex arrived late at 6:30 and looked for his black gloves. A note was on the floor.”

Task 1 – Listening Grid

1. Mrs Grey – Great Hall – 5:45 – owl – last saw
2. Cora – library – 6:00–6:25 – shadow – saw
3. Ms Hollow – art room – evening – pumpkins – painting
4. Ben – hall – 5:40 – — – finished cleaning & left
5. Alex – school – 6:30 – black gloves – arrived & looked

Task 2 – Listen & Order

C – E – D – F – B – A

Task 3 – Find the Clue

1. 5:45 pm 2. a shadow past the window 3. art room 4. his black gloves

Task 4 – Timeline

5:40 Ben left | 5:45 owl last seen | 6:00 lights flickered | 6:10 loud noise | 6:15 Cora saw shadow | 6:30 Alex arrived

Task 6 – Clue Unlock

1. will find 2. 6:10 3. Cora 4. False 5. will show

Task 7 – Possible / Impossible

1. Impossible (left at 5:40)
2. Impossible (was in library)
3. Possible (was in art room)
4. Impossible (arrived at 6:30)
5. Possible
6. Impossible / Low reliability

Final Verdict – Model Answer

Ms Hollow most likely moved the owl to the art room to prepare a Halloween surprise. Evidence: she was in the art room all evening; Cora saw a shadow at 6:15. I reject the idea that Alex took it because he only arrived at 6:30. If we check the art room, we will find the owl.

3-minute Reflection / Exit Ticket

1. Which clue helped you most? Why?
2. Write one Conditional 1 sentence about the case.
3. What will you do first if you investigate another mystery?

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